



State Employment
Leadership Network

Monthly Network Meeting

September 21, 2016

SELN Monthly Network Meeting: September 21, 2016

AGENDA

Welcome to everyone!

- Brief intros
- Housekeeping

Discussion

Provider Organizational Transformation and Integrated Employment

Project Business

- SELN Annual Meeting, October 4-6
- Hub update (www.selnhub.org)

Conferences/Meetings – see last slide



NASDDDS



Provider Organizational Transformation and Integrated Employment

A project of



at the Institute for Community Inclusion, UMass Boston



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**RRTC on Advancing
Employment for
Individuals with IDD**



- ❑ Individual and family knowledge & engagement
- ❑ Effective employment supports
- ❑ Organizational change for community providers
- ❑ State-level policy and strategy

www.thinkwork.org



Guiding Research Questions

- *What elements are necessary for successful organizational transformation towards integrated employment at the provider level?*
- *What do these elements look like in practice?*
- *How can state systems prioritize activities to best support providers?*
- *What are some state system strategies we can share?*



Supporting providers to evolve
their service delivery framework

- Through:
- a model framework for building capacity
 - a toolkit to guide organizations through the process
 - an efficient scalable strategy (a facilitated, peer-to-peer learning community) for supporting transformation across networks of providers.



Research Activities

- Two main research activities that frame our presentation (Delphi Process and case studies)
- Delphi panel to identify critical elements and case studies to show those elements on the ground
- Delphi Process is complete, but case studies in process of collecting data



Purpose of the Delphi Panel

- Method for getting a group of experts to agree on a topic
- “What is most important for providers during transformation?”
- 2 rounds (identify and then rank)
- See if feedback supports what the research says ...and what can it add?



Who participated in the Delphi ?

- 36 experts in the field of organizational transformation
- Represented a range of stakeholder groups (provider staff and management, self-advocates, families)
- Had knowledge of, or had participated in, a transformation process



Purpose of the case studies

- Provide examples of what Delphi characteristics look like on the ground
- Provide depth as to how the characteristics can be implemented
- Provide detail and resources to populate our Toolkit
- Provide us with a state systems context as it relates to the provider experience



Who participated in the case studies?

- AtWork! - Bellevue, WA (Seattle metro)
- Work, Inc. – Dorchester, MA (Boston metro and Cape Cod)
- The Arc of Westchester – Westchester County (NYC metro)
- Penn-Mar Human Services - Glen Rock, PA (rural)



How did we choose them?

- 28 individual organizations were nominated by Delphi panelists, research team members and others
- Web research and follow-up using 3 inclusion criteria lead to 9 finalists
- Phone-based screening interviews resulted in 4 finalists...



Discussion Poll

Ranking the top 10 characteristics of transformative providers in order of their importance



Characteristic #1: Have clear and consistent goals

Establish an explicit commitment to increase employment.

Goals should be:

- measurable
- flexible
- compelling and easy to grasp
- directly reflective of the core mission
- specific to an established time frame.



Characteristic #2: Agency culture

- Guides what the agency will do (support people to work in the community) and not do (sheltered work/subminimum wage).
- Values positive thinking, learning, creativity, innovation and continuous quality improvement.
- Transmitted through values-based training, ongoing technical assistance, and mentoring of staff that take calculated risks to support positive outcomes.



Characteristic #3: An active, person-centered job placement process is accessible to all, including those with the most significant disabilities

- Find jobs for 1 person at a time.
- This “just do it” approach creates momentum and enthusiasm; recognize and celebrate achieved employment outcomes.



Characteristic #4: Communicate expectations often and to all

Internally, intent is communicated:

- By simple, visible practices and daily decisions,
- with employment as a clear and authentic expectation.

Externally, by:

- how money is spent,
- goals-based data tracking,
- policy initiatives,
- simple outreach activities such as newsletters, and
- conversations during all family meetings.



Characteristic #5: Reallocate and restructure all resources

- Reinvent job positions and expectations to clearly focus on employment outcomes
- continuous opportunities for staff development.
- How organizations invest their resources is a direct reflection of priorities, and it has a significant influence on outcomes.



Characteristic #6: Ongoing professional development of staff

- Frequent and ongoing training, continuing education, conference participation, and mentorship opportunities lead to core competencies and implementation of best practices.
- Support employees at all levels to meaningfully contribute their ideas and energy to the mission.



Characteristic #7: Customer focus and engagement

- Partner with stakeholders (including self-advocates, families, and the business community)
- Identify and solve workforce issues by matching need with interests and skills for a mutually beneficial outcome.



Characteristic #8: Employment performance measurement, quality assurance, and program oversight.

- Share accountability across all staff
- Understand baseline data
- Technology-enabled systems for tracking individual outcomes and staff activities

"What gets measured, gets done."



Characteristic #9: Embrace a holistic approach throughout the employment process

- Consider the whole person
- Include a career planning process that involves multiple stakeholders (staff, parents, friends.)
- Pay attention to maintaining personal relationships as well as developing new ones.



Characteristic #10: Develop multiple and diverse community partnerships

- Create buy in to the change process
- Include local businesses, school districts, state agency offices, faith-based organizations
- Effective partnerships:
 - promote actions that improve outcomes
 - foster positive change within systems
 - meet local economic needs



Discussion Poll

Any surprises?
Do the examples resonate with
experiences in your state?



Missouri's story

Technical Support on Transformation Efforts to
Two State Centers

- "Walk the talk" – Contextual understanding, analysis of system, resource design and empathy
- Transformation of 2 State Operated Programs
- Describing the destination
- Exploring values, strengths, needs, opportunities and obstacles
- Messaging – values and opportunities (WIIFM)



Massachusetts' story

Influence of Blueprint and Priority
Activities with Providers



Questions to Take Back

- What does your state’s environment for supporting providers look like?
- What strategies has your state implemented? What still needs to be done?
- What state level messaging is necessary to support provider transformation?
- What steps need to be taken to move your state’s agenda forward?



Next Steps and
For More Information

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Annual Meeting Pre-survey



Registered for our meeting? One set of responses from each attending state:
<http://www.surveymongo.com/s3/3054483/SELN-2016-Annual-Meeting-State-Activities>

Hub
Orientations
30 minutes



Calendar

Hub 101

- Thursday, 9/22 at 11am ET
- Friday, 9/23 at 11am ET

Using Monthly Network
Meeting and Annual Meeting
Groups

- Thursday, 9/22 at 2pm ET
- Friday, 9/23 at 2pm ET

Connection details
are on the Hub.



Upcoming events for the calendar:

Online:

Monthly network meetings

- 9am HT/ 12pm PT/ 1pm MT/ 2pm CT/ 3pm ET (90 minutes)
- Next meeting November 16th
- Third Wednesday of each month
- No meetings in August or October

SELN Annual Meeting

- Alexandria, VA
- October 4-6



State Employment Leadership Network

The State Employment Leadership Network is a network of state intellectual and developmental disability agencies working together to improve employment outcomes for individuals. The SELN is a joint program of the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston and the National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services.

www.seln.org

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